Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 8

Unity in Diversity, or ‘Many in the One’

नीचे आपकी PDF के आधार पर पाठ के सभी मुख्य प्रश्नों, गतिविधियों और अभ्यास-प्रश्नों के उत्तर simple English में दिए गए हैं। इसके बाद प्रत्येक टॉपिक से महत्वपूर्ण और संभावित परीक्षा-प्रश्नों के उत्तर भी दिए गए हैं।

Part 1: Answers to the Big Questions

Q1. What is meant by ‘unity in diversity’ in the Indian scenario?

Answer: Unity in diversity means that people in India have different languages, foods, dresses, festivals, customs and traditions, but they share a common cultural identity. These differences do not divide us. They make our country richer.

Q2. What aspects of India’s diversity are the most striking?

Answer: The most striking aspects of India’s diversity are its different landscapes, languages, scripts, food habits, clothes, festivals, customs and traditions. People from different regions follow different ways of life.

Q3. How do we make out the unity underlying the diversity?

Answer: We can see unity in the common food grains and spices used across India, the sari worn in many regions, festivals celebrated under different names, and stories such as the Ramayana, Mahabharata and Panchatantra that are shared across communities.

Part 2: Answers to “Let’s Explore” Activities

A. A Rich Diversity (Page 126)

Q1. What can we learn by comparing the birthplaces and languages of our classmates?

Answer: We learn that classmates may come from different places and speak different mother tongues. Some may also know more than one language. This shows the diversity of India.

B. Food for All (Page 128)

Q2. Make a list of ingredients used in your home.

Answer: Some common ingredients used in my home are rice, wheat flour, pulses, vegetables, mustard oil, turmeric, cumin, coriander, ginger, garlic and salt.

Q3. Take any one vegetable and think of the number of different dishes you can prepare with it.

Answer: We can prepare many dishes from potatoes, such as potato curry, fried potatoes, potato paratha, potato chips, potato cutlets and potato fritters.

C. Textiles and Clothing (Page 129)

Q4. Explain how the example of the sari reflects both unity and diversity in 100–150 words.

Answer:

The sari is a good example of unity in diversity in India. It is a traditional dress worn by women in many parts of the country. This shows unity. However, saris differ in their fabric, colours, designs, weaving methods and styles of wearing. Banarasi, Kanjivaram, Paithani, Patan Patola, Muga and Mysore are some famous types of silk saris. Some saris are made of cotton, while others are made of silk or synthetic fabrics. Different communities also have different ways of draping a sari. Thus, the sari is one type of dress with many regional forms. It shows that India has a common cultural tradition with great variety.

D. Different Uses of a Sari (Page 130)

Q5. Can you recognise what a sari has been used for in the pictures?

Answer: A sari can be used for purposes other than wearing it as a dress. Depending on the situation, it can be used as a cloth for carrying or covering things, as a makeshift support or as a useful household cloth.

Q6. Can you imagine more uses for a sari?

Answer: A sari can be used as a bedsheet, curtain, blanket, cradle cloth, a covering for stored items or a cloth for carrying things.

E. The Dhoti (Page 131)

Q7. What conclusion can you draw from the different styles and uses of the dhoti?

Answer: The dhoti is worn in different styles in different regions. Its fabric, way of wearing and uses may vary. This shows diversity in clothing, while the dhoti remains a common traditional garment.

F. Festivals Galore (Page 132)

Q8. What is your favourite festival, and how is it celebrated in your region? Is it celebrated elsewhere under another name?

Answer: My favourite festival is Makar Sankranti. It is celebrated around 14 January in many parts of India. People prepare special foods, take part in local customs and celebrate the harvest season. Similar festivals are known by different names in different regions.

Q9. Name some festivals celebrated around the same time in different parts of India.

Answer: The textbook map on page 132 gives these examples of festivals celebrated around the same time:

- Lohri or Maghi – parts of northern India
- Uttarayan – Gujarat
- Makar Sankranti – several regions
- Pongal – Tamil Nadu
- Magh Bihu – Assam
- Khichdi Parv – some parts of northern India
- Poush Sankranti – Bengal
- Pedda Panduga – Andhra region

These festivals show how similar seasonal celebrations can have different names and customs.

Q10. Name some major festivals celebrated during October–November.

Answer: Some major festivals celebrated during October–November are Diwali, Dussehra, Durga Puja, Kali Puja and Chhath Puja. The exact dates and customs may vary by region and year.

G. An Epic Spread (Pages 133–135)

Q11. What is the Panchatantra?

Answer: The Panchatantra is a collection of stories, mainly featuring animals. These stories teach important life lessons. The original text was written in Sanskrit at least 2,200 years ago. Its stories have been adapted into many Indian and foreign languages.

Q12. What do the Ramayana and the Mahabharata teach us?

Answer: The Ramayana and the Mahabharata are two great Sanskrit epics of India. They tell stories of heroes who struggle to establish dharma. They teach us about right and wrong, duty, courage and moral values.

Q13. Describe the main story of the Ramayana.

Answer: The Ramayana tells the story of Rama, who defeats Ravana with the help of his brother Lakshmana and Hanuman. Ravana had kidnapped Rama's wife, Sita. The epic teaches the importance of duty and the struggle between right and wrong.

Q14. Describe the main story of the Mahabharata.

Answer: The Mahabharata tells the story of the Pandavas and the Kauravas, who were cousins. With Krishna's help, the Pandavas fought the Kauravas to recover their kingdom. The epic explores duty, justice and moral choices.

Q15. How have the Ramayana and the Mahabharata contributed to unity in diversity?

Answer: These epics have been translated and adapted into many Indian languages for more than 2,000 years. Different regions and communities have developed their own versions. They have also inspired folk stories, paintings, sculptures, dances and other art forms. In this way, they have connected people across India and parts of Asia.

Q16. How do tribal communities preserve their own versions of these epics?

Answer: Tribal communities such as the Bhils, Gonds and Mundas preserve their own versions of the Ramayana and the Mahabharata. Many of these stories are passed from one generation to another through oral traditions. They may also include local legends about the heroes visiting their regions.

Q17. What does the stone called 'Pancha Pandavar' represent?

Answer: The stone shown on page 135 depicts the five Pandava brothers. It is located in a forest in the Nilgiris, Tamil Nadu. The shrine is maintained by Irula tribal people to remember the Pandavas' supposed visit to the area.

H. Questions and Activities at the End of the Chapter (Page 136)

Q18. Explain the two quotations given at the beginning of the chapter.

Answer: Rabindranath Tagore's quotation expresses the joy of finding unity among many different things. Sri Aurobindo's quotation explains that unity in diversity is an important feature of India. Both quotations show that India can remain united while respecting its differences.

Q19. Select a story from the Panchatantra and explain its message.

Answer: The story of The Monkey and the Crocodile teaches us to remain calm and use our intelligence in difficult situations. The monkey saves himself by thinking wisely. The story teaches us that intelligence can help us overcome danger.

Q20. Why should we collect folk tales from our region?

Answer: Folk tales help us understand the history, beliefs, customs and values of our region. They preserve local knowledge and pass cultural traditions from one generation to another.

Q21. How can ancient stories be shown through art?

Answer: Ancient stories can be shown through paintings, sculptures, dance performances, theatre, music and films. These art forms help people understand and remember stories from the past.

Q22. What did Jawaharlal Nehru observe about Indian culture?

Answer: Jawaharlal Nehru observed that people in different parts of India shared a common cultural background. Stories from the Ramayana and the Mahabharata were widely known, even among villagers who could not read. These stories influenced people's lives and taught them moral values.

Part 3: Important Questions and Answers from Every Topic

Topic 1: A Rich Diversity

Q1. What is diversity?

Answer: Diversity means the presence of differences among people, such as differences in language, food, dress, religion, customs and traditions.

Q2. Why is India called a diverse country?

Answer: India is called a diverse country because its people speak different languages, wear different clothes, eat different foods and celebrate different festivals. Its landscapes and traditions also vary from region to region.

Q3. What was the People of India project?

Answer: The People of India project was a major survey conducted by the Anthropological Survey of India in the late 20th century. It studied 4,635 communities across the country and recorded 325 languages using 25 scripts.

Q4. Who was Vincent Smith? What did he say about India?

Answer: Vincent Smith was a British historian. He observed that India had great diversity, but also an underlying unity that made it possible to study Indian history as a whole.

Q5. What is meant by an underlying unity?

Answer: Underlying unity means the common cultural connections and shared traditions that exist among people despite their differences.

Topic 2: Food for All

Q6. What are staple grains?

Answer: Staple grains are basic food grains eaten regularly by a large number of people. Rice, wheat, barley and millets are examples.

Q7. Name three types of millets mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Pearl millet (bajra), sorghum (jowar) and finger millet (ragi).

Q8. Name some spices commonly used throughout India.

Answer: Turmeric, cumin, cardamom and ginger are some spices commonly used throughout India.

Q9. How does food show unity in diversity?

Answer: Many regions use common grains, pulses and spices, but prepare different dishes from them. Thus, the ingredients show unity, while the variety of dishes shows diversity.

Q10. Why do food habits differ from one region to another?

Answer: Food habits differ because of differences in climate, crops, local ingredients, traditions and people's tastes.

Topic 3: Textiles and Clothing

Q11. What is a sari?

Answer: A sari is a long, unstitched piece of cloth worn by women in many parts of India.

Q12. Name five famous types of silk saris mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Banarasi, Kanjivaram, Paithani, Patan Patola and Muga. Mysore silk is another example.

Q13. What is a relief in sculpture?

Answer: A relief is a design or figure that stands out from the surface of a panel or other material.

Q14. What was chintz, and why was it important?

Answer: Chintz was a beautiful type of printed cotton cloth made in India. It became very popular in 17th-century Europe. England and France eventually banned its import to protect their own textile products.

Q15. How does traditional clothing show regional diversity?

Answer: Different regions use different fabrics, colours, designs, weaving methods and styles of wearing clothes. These differences reflect local traditions and skills.

Topic 4: Festivals Galore

Q16. What is Makar Sankranti associated with?

Answer: Makar Sankranti marks the beginning of the harvest season in many parts of India and is celebrated around 14 January.

Q17. Why do similar festivals have different names in India?

Answer: Different regions have their own languages, customs, foods and ways of celebrating. Therefore, similar seasonal festivals may have different names and traditions.

Q18. How do festivals promote unity?

Answer: Festivals bring families and communities together. Similar festivals celebrated in different regions help people recognise their shared traditions despite local differences.

Topic 5: An Epic Spread

Q19. What is an epic?

Answer: An epic is a long poem or literary work that narrates the adventures of heroes and other important figures of the past.

Q20. What is the main lesson of the Panchatantra?

Answer: The Panchatantra teaches practical life lessons through entertaining stories, often using animals as characters.

Q21. What is dharma in the context of the two epics?

Answer: In the chapter, dharma refers to duty and the right way of acting. The Ramayana and the Mahabharata explore the struggle to establish dharma.

Q22. How did the epics spread beyond India?

Answer: The Ramayana and the Mahabharata were translated and adapted into different languages and forms. Their stories travelled to many parts of Asia and influenced local literature and culture.

Q23. What is an oral tradition?

Answer: An oral tradition is the passing of stories, songs, beliefs and knowledge from one generation to another by speaking and listening rather than only through written texts.

Q24. Why are there different versions of the Ramayana and the Mahabharata?

Answer: Different regions and communities have adapted the stories to their own languages, customs and traditions. As a result, many regional and folk versions have developed.

Q25. What role have tribal communities played in preserving Indian epics?

Answer: Many tribal communities have preserved their own versions of the epics and local legends through oral storytelling. These traditions connect the epics with the histories and places of different communities.

Part 4: True or False

Write True or False for each statement.

1. India has diversity in languages, food, clothes and festivals. — True
2. People throughout India wear exactly the same clothes. — False
3. Rice, wheat and millets are examples of staple grains. — True
4. The sari is worn in only one style throughout India. — False
5. Chintz was a type of printed cotton cloth. — True
6. Makar Sankranti is associated with the harvest season in many parts of India. — True
7. The Panchatantra contains stories that teach life lessons. — True
8. The Ramayana and Mahabharata have only one version each. — False
9. Tribal communities have preserved their own versions of Indian epics. — True
10. Diversity always divides people and makes unity impossible. — False

Part 5: Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs)

Practice Test

0 of 12 answered

1. What does ‘unity in diversity’ mean?

A. Everyone follows the same customs
B. People remain united despite differences

C. Everyone speaks one language
D. All regions have the same food

2. Which organisation conducted the People of India project?

A. Archaeological Survey of India
B. Anthropological Survey of India
C. Survey of India
D. Election Commission of India

3. Which of these is a staple grain?

A. Cardamom
B. Rice
C. Ginger
D. Turmeric

4. Which of these is a type of millet?

A. Bajra
B. Rajma
C. Masoor
D. Basmati

5. What is a sari?

A. A stitched jacket
B. A long, unstitched piece of cloth
C. A type of grain
D. A musical instrument

6. What was chintz?

A. A printed cotton cloth
B. A silk thread
C. A festival
D. A type of epic

7. Makar Sankranti is associated with which season in many regions?

A. Planting season only
B. Harvest season
C. Monsoon season only
D. Winter sports season

8. Which festival is known as Pongal in Tamil Nadu?

A. A harvest-related festival
B. A textile fair
C. A book festival
D. A mountain festival

9. Which collection of stories is at least 2,200 years old in its original Sanskrit form?

A. Panchatantra
B. Arthashastra
C. A modern novel
D. A travel diary

10. Who helps Rama defeat Ravana in the Ramayana?

A. The Kauravas
B. Lakshmana and Hanuman
C. The Panchatantra animals
D. The five Pandavas

11. Who are the main groups in the Mahabharata conflict?

A. Pandavas and Kauravas
B. Rama and Ravana
C. Bhils and Gonds
D. Cholas and Pandyas

12. How have many tribal communities preserved their epic traditions?

A. Only through printed newspapers
B. Through oral traditions and local versions
C. By avoiding stories
D. Only through foreign books
Check Answers

Part 6: Quick Revision Notes

Learn these points before the examination.

- Unity in diversity: Different ways of life with shared cultural connections.
- People of India project: Survey of 4,635 communities, recording 325 languages using 25 scripts, as stated in the chapter.
- Staple grains: Rice, wheat, barley and millets.
- Common spices: Turmeric, cumin, cardamom and ginger.
- Traditional clothing: The sari is a common garment with many regional varieties and ways of wearing it.
- Chintz: Indian printed cotton cloth that became popular in Europe.

- Makar Sankranti: A harvest-related festival celebrated under different names in different regions.
- Panchatantra: A collection of stories that teach life lessons.
- Ramayana: The story of Rama’s struggle against Ravana.
- Mahabharata: The story of the conflict between the Pandavas and Kauravas.
- Oral tradition: Passing stories and knowledge from one generation to another by speaking and listening.
- Main message of the chapter: Diversity enriches India; it does not have to divide its people.

These answers follow the topics, examples, maps and end-of-chapter questions in your uploaded textbook, Unity in Diversity, or ‘Many in the One’, pages 125–136.

ssc6-cbse-ch08-unity-in-diversity.pdf